
DESIGN PROPOSAL · 02

One design system, *every* screen

The product currently ships four incompatible visual languages. This proposal replaces them with a single editorial system — scholarly serif display, disciplined green, paper-calm surfaces — applied to every page, keeping the white-and-green identity the product already owns.

Foundations

Type · color · space · voice

Components

One library, both form factors

Six key screens

Landing · auth · dashboard · wizard · reader · Topic Lab

Four themes today → one system

SHIPPING TODAY — SIMULTANEOUSLY



1 • Landing

Custom CSS, dark hero, own button styles



2 • Core auth

Green split-panel, Sora/DM Sans, own CSS file



3 • Peripheral auth

Tailwind blue/purple gradients, lucide icons



4 • Dashboard

g-* classes + heavy inline style={{}} per element

Plus a fifth, fully dead system in `components/ui/`, ~150 lines of unreachable navy CSS, and ~90 hand-rolled icon functions duplicated across 9 files. Every new page rolls dice on which language it speaks.

THE COST

Inconsistency reads as unfinished — for a product asking students to trust it with graded work, visual coherence *is* credibility. And every duplicated style is a bug surface (the status-color typo that hid completed projects lived in exactly this duplication).

THE PROPOSED VOICE — "SCHOLARLY, CALM, GREEN"

EDITORIAL IDENTITY

Research is a *craft*.
The interface should read like
one.

- 1 **Fraunces** (a scholarly display serif, already sneaking into dashboard headings) becomes the *deliberate* voice for every display heading and document surface.
- 2 **DM Sans** carries all UI: labels, buttons, body, data. Sora retires to the wordmark only.
- 3 **One green** (#16a34a) for every action; #4ade80 only as accent on dark. Blue/purple exit entirely.
- 4 **Dark forest (#0f1f0f)** is **structural**, not decorative: hero, sidebar, CTA band — the three "moments", everything else stays paper-white.
- 5 **Dot-grid + green glow** is the single recurring texture, only ever on dark surfaces.

Tokens — color, type, space

COLOR — SEMANTIC, NOT DECORATIVE

ink / forest
#0f10f

action green
#16a34a

accent (on dark)
#4ade80

green tint
#f0fdf4

paper
#fbfcfb

canvas
#f6f8f6

body text
#374151

hairline
#e8ede8

✓ good #16a34a

🕒 running #d97706

✗ failed #dc2626

ℹ info #2563eb

Status colors are reserved — never used as decoration, always paired with an icon or word.

SPACE & SHAPE

4px base grid · radii 10 (inputs) / 14 (cards) / 18 (modals) · borders 1px hairline, 1.5px on interactive · two shadows only: *rest* (0 1 3 · 7%) and *raised* (0 8 24 · 8%)

TYPE — TWO FAMILIES, FIVE SIZES

Display — Fraunces 600

Page titles, hero, document headings · 30–56px

Wordmark — Sora 800 only

ResearchAI logotype, nothing else

Heading — DM Sans 700 · 16–20px

Card titles, section heads

Body — DM Sans 400/500 · 14–15px, 1.6 line-height

LABEL — DM SANS 700 · 10–11PX CAPS, .12EM TRACKING

Document — Georgia/Fraunces 15–16px · 1.75 — the generated specification always reads like a manuscript, never like UI.

WHY A SERIF-LED SYSTEM

The product's output is an academic document. Letting manuscript typography lead the brand makes the interface feel like the artifact it produces — and instantly distinguishes it from every Inter-gray AI tool.

One component library

BUTTONS

Primary

Tinted

Outline

Destructive

Text link →

INPUTS & SELECTION

Placeholder...

Focused value

Chip · on

Chip

Toggle

STATUS — BADGE + DOT + WORD, NEVER COLOR ALONE

● COMPLETE

● RUNNING

● FAILED

● BYOK

● PENDING

FEEDBACK — REPLACES ALERT() / CONFIRM()

✓ Toast — “Specification downloaded”

Confirm sheet

“Delete project?” · Cancel / Delete

CARDS — THREE ALTITUDES

Rest

hairline + rest shadow

Raised / hover

green-warm border

Moment

dark + dots + glow — key actions only

STAT TILE & SCORE BAR

12

TOTAL SPECS

Methodology

18/20

Literature review

15/20

Numbers in ink, never green — color marks accents and actions, not data. Bars are single-hue (magnitude), value-labeled directly.

ICONOGRAPHY

🏠

📁

💡

🔗

🛡️

⬇️

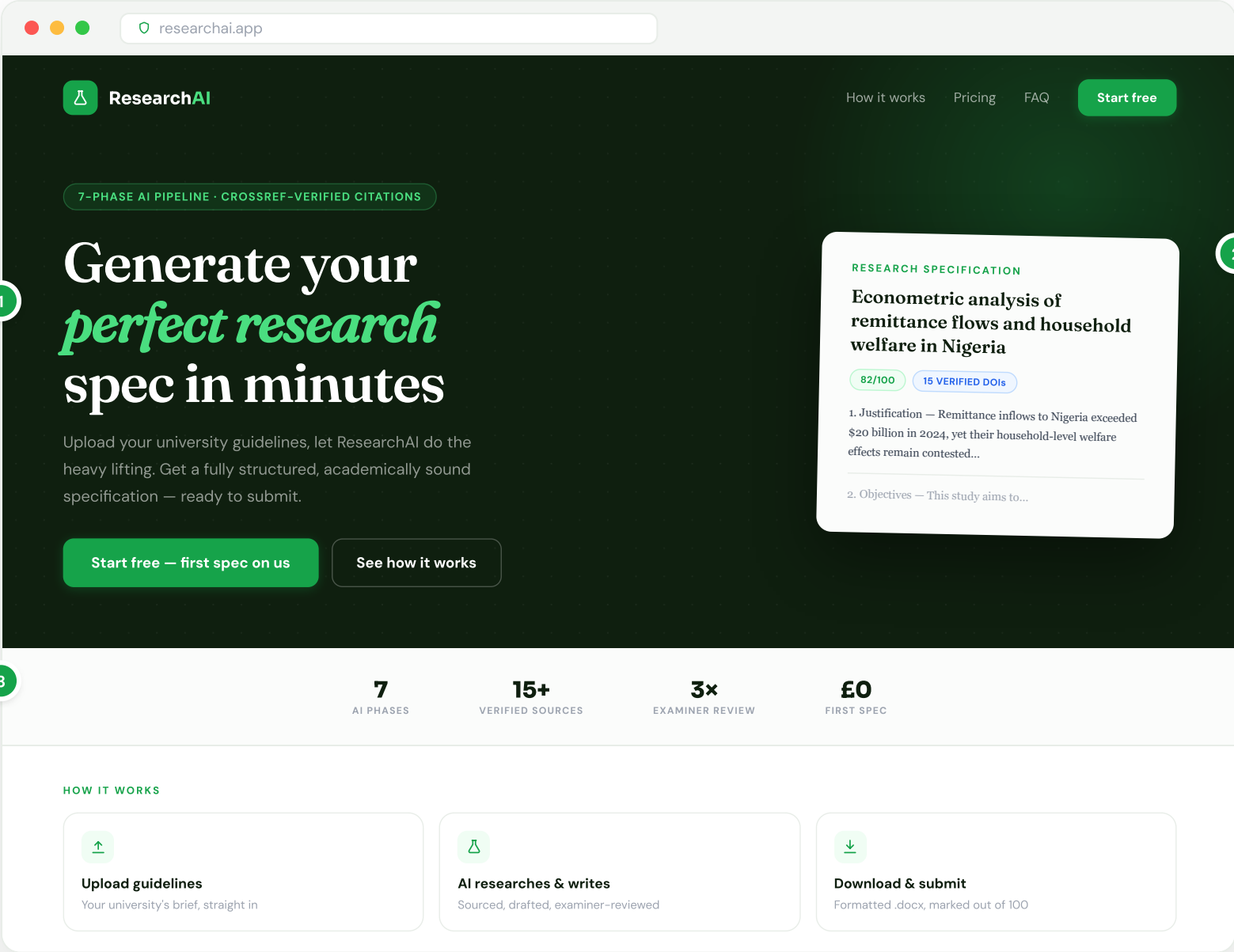
lucide-react only

(already a dependency) — 2px stroke, 18/20px. The ~90 hand-rolled SVG functions across 9 files are deleted on contact.

BUILD NOTE

These are ~12 primitives in *components/ui/* (replacing the dead Button/Card there today), styled by the tokens on sheet 3 — CSS variables in *globals.css*, consumed by both desktop and the mobile patterns from document 01. Inline *style={{}}* is banned by convention thereafter.

Landing — the manuscript hero



1 Same hero copy, manuscript voice.

Fraunces at display size against the forest dark + dot grid — the landing finally speaks the same language as the auth pages instead of its own.

2 The product IS the hero image: a

tilted paper spec card — real title, real mark, real verified-DOI badge — instead of abstract dashboard screenshots. It shows the artifact a student actually walks away with.

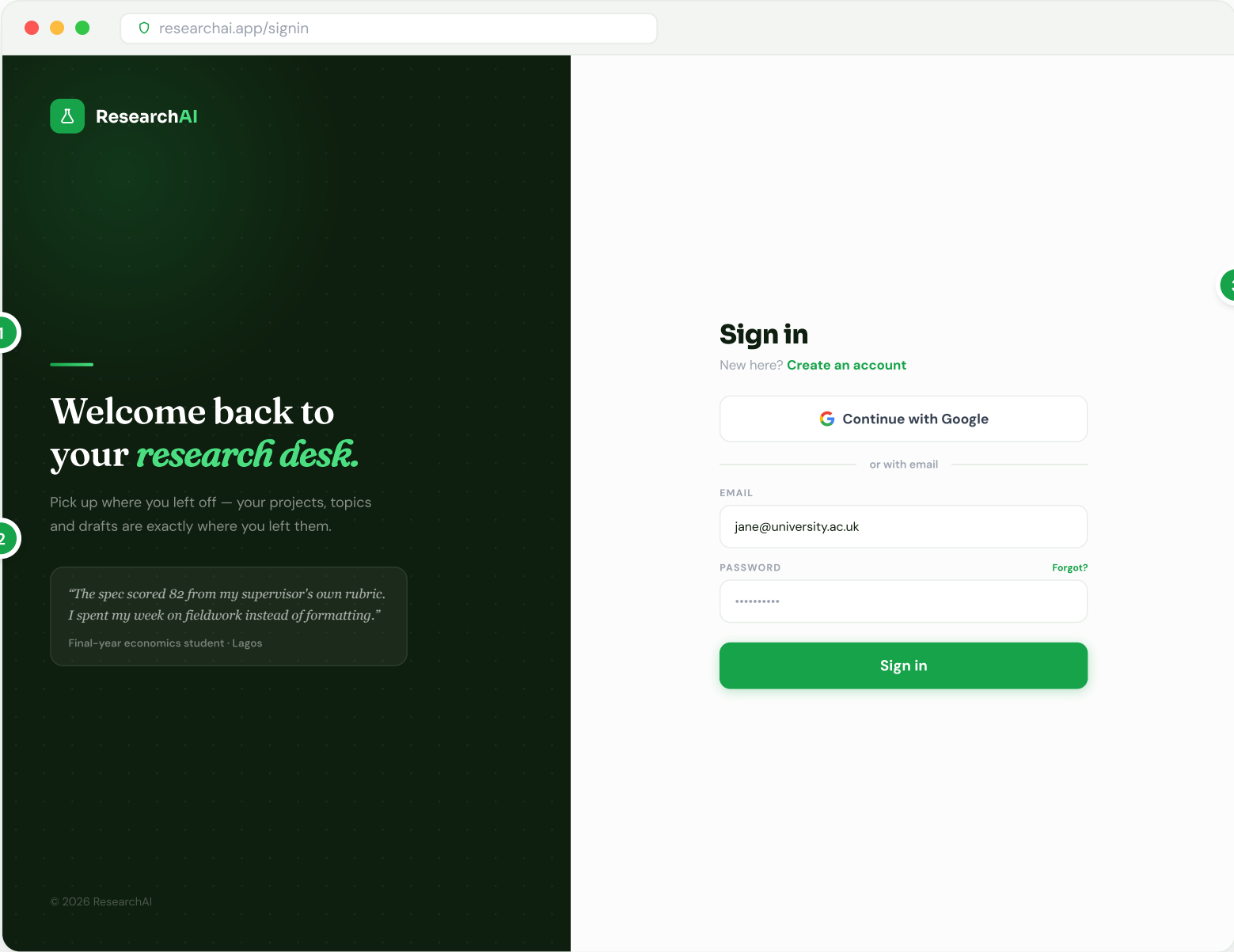
3 Proof strip + three steps on paper-

white, stat numbers in ink. Below the fold (not shown): feature grid, one testimonial, pricing (Free / £9.99 / £24.99), dark CTA band reprising the hero.

HONEST CLAIMS ONLY

Every number on this page is real product behavior: 7 phases, CrossRef verification, examiner-style review iterations, the free first spec. No invented logos, no fake user counts — trust is the product here.

Auth — the strongest page, refined

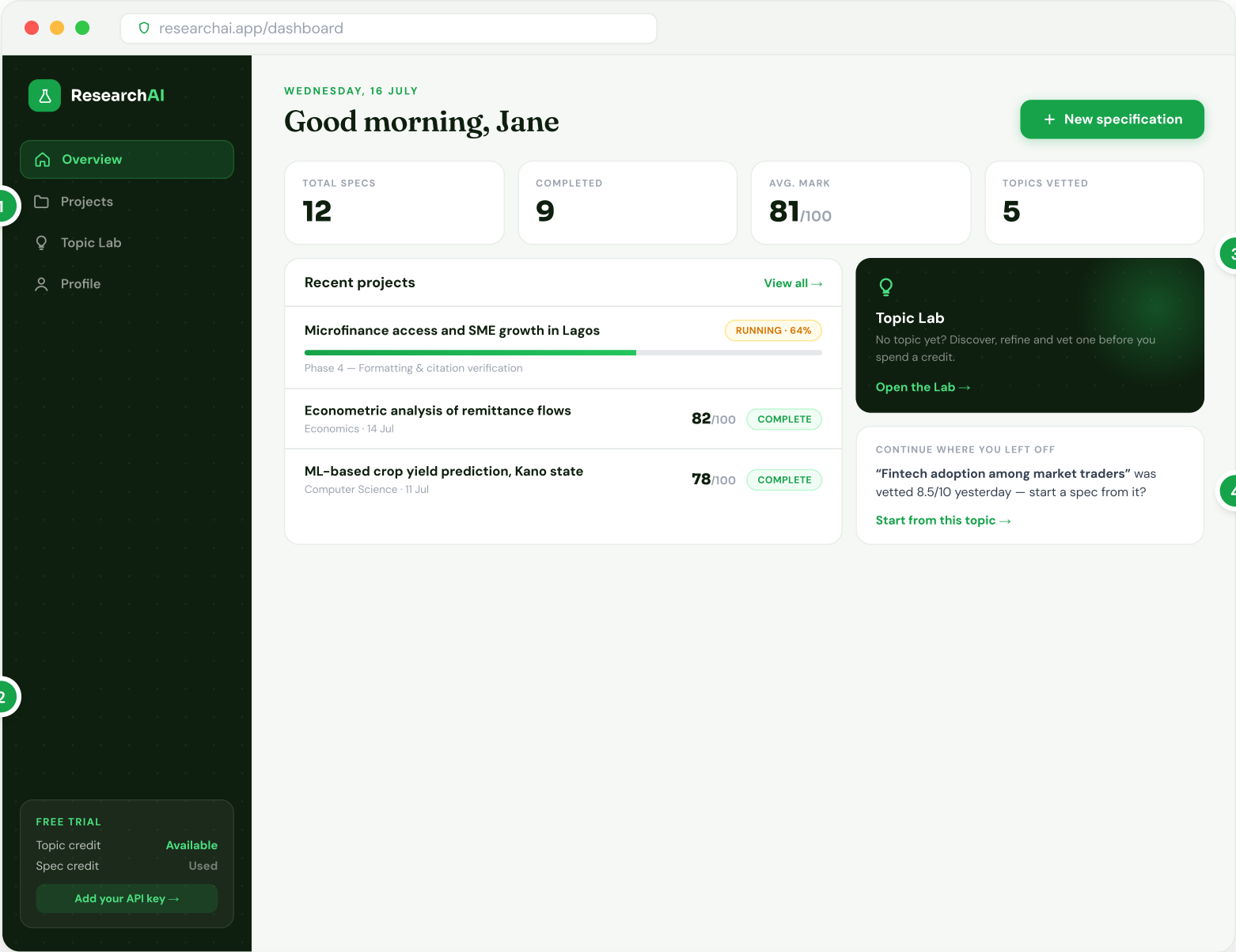


- 1 This page was already the best thing in the product — the redesign keeps its bones and promotes its language (forest panel, glow, dot grid, green *em*) to the whole system.
- 2 Proof card becomes a single human quote in manuscript italic instead of three feature bullets — auth pages persuade with warmth, not specs.
- 3 Form on paper (`#fbfcfb`), inputs on white — a two-surface hierarchy so focus states genuinely pop. "Create an account" moves up beside the heading where the eye starts.

PERIPHERAL AUTH PAGES JOIN THE FAMILY

Register, verify-email, forgot/reset-password — currently the blue/purple Tailwind outliers — adopt this exact layout with the panel copy swapped. Five pages, one template, zero new CSS.

Dashboard — the research desk



- 1 **The sidebar goes forest-dark** — the app's one structural "moment" indoors. Active item = green-tinted pill; four items only.
- 2 **Trial/BYOK status lives in the sidebar footer** — always visible, one tap from adding a key; the upsell is ambient, never a popup.
- 3 **Serif greeting** + one primary action. Stat row in ink (Avg. mark joins — the number that actually motivates), each tile one figure, no sparkline noise.
- 4 **A right rail that thinks:** Topic Lab as the dark moment card, plus a "continue where you left off" suggestion wired from real Topic Lab history — the dashboard starts conversations instead of just reporting.

SAME DATA, ZERO NEW ENDPOINTS

Everything here is served by existing hooks (`useProjects`, `useUser`, `/user/stats`, topic history). The redesign is presentation-only.

Generate — a calm, three-act wizard

researchai.app/dashboard/generate

New specification

✓ Basics
Education Policy · Master's

2 Configure
Documents & model quality

3 Review & generate

COST, UPFRONT
Standard tier on your free credit:
£0
. Estimated time: 8–12 min for 2 review iterations.

Configure generation

Everything the pipeline needs to write like your department expects.

UNIVERSITY GUIDELINES (.DOCX)

UNILAG_project_guidelines.docx
248 KB · parsed ✓

DATASET (optional)

Drop .csv / .xlsx — we'll profile it for the methodology

MODEL QUALITY

Standard
Best balance of quality and speed — recommended
FREE CREDIT OK

Premium
Strongest models on every agent, slower
REQUIRES YOUR KEY

Custom
Choose a model per agent, per phase
Configure →

REVIEW ITERATIONS

2

3

5

Each iteration re-examines and rewrites only the sections that under-scored.

Back

Continue

- Vertical stepper with receipts:**
completed steps show their choices ("Education Policy · Master's") — the form remembers out loud, and any step is clickable to revisit.
- Cost and time, before the button:**
the sidebar states what this run costs (free credit / BYOK) and how long it takes. No surprise 402s, no spinner anxiety.
- Tier cards teach the BYOK model** at decision time — FREE CREDIT OK vs. REQUIRES YOUR KEY — and iteration count explains targeted regeneration in one sentence, turning a config knob into a product story.

ACT THREE

Review & Generate shows a manuscript-style summary card (like the landing hero's paper card) of every choice, then one green button. Submitting lands on the live progress screen — the same phase-checklist pattern as mobile, at desktop width.

Spec reader — a manuscript, not a data dump

researchai.app/dashboard/projects/42

CONTENTS

Justification

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Literature review

Methodology

Work plan

References

Abstract

COMPLETE

15 VERIFIED DOIs

ITERATION 2/3

Econometric analysis of remittance flows and household welfare in Nigeria

82 OVERALL

1 • Justification

Remittance inflows to Nigeria exceeded \$20 billion in 2024, yet their household-level welfare effects remain contested. Existing studies rely largely on cross-sectional snapshots that cannot separate transitory consumption smoothing from durable welfare gains. This study exploits three waves of the General Household Survey to estimate...

EXAMINER'S NOTE · 16/20

"Strong empirical motivation. Consider citing the 2025 CBN remittance bulletin for the headline figure."

Download .docx

Regenerate weak sections

EXAMINER'S MARKS

Methodology18/20

Objectives17/20

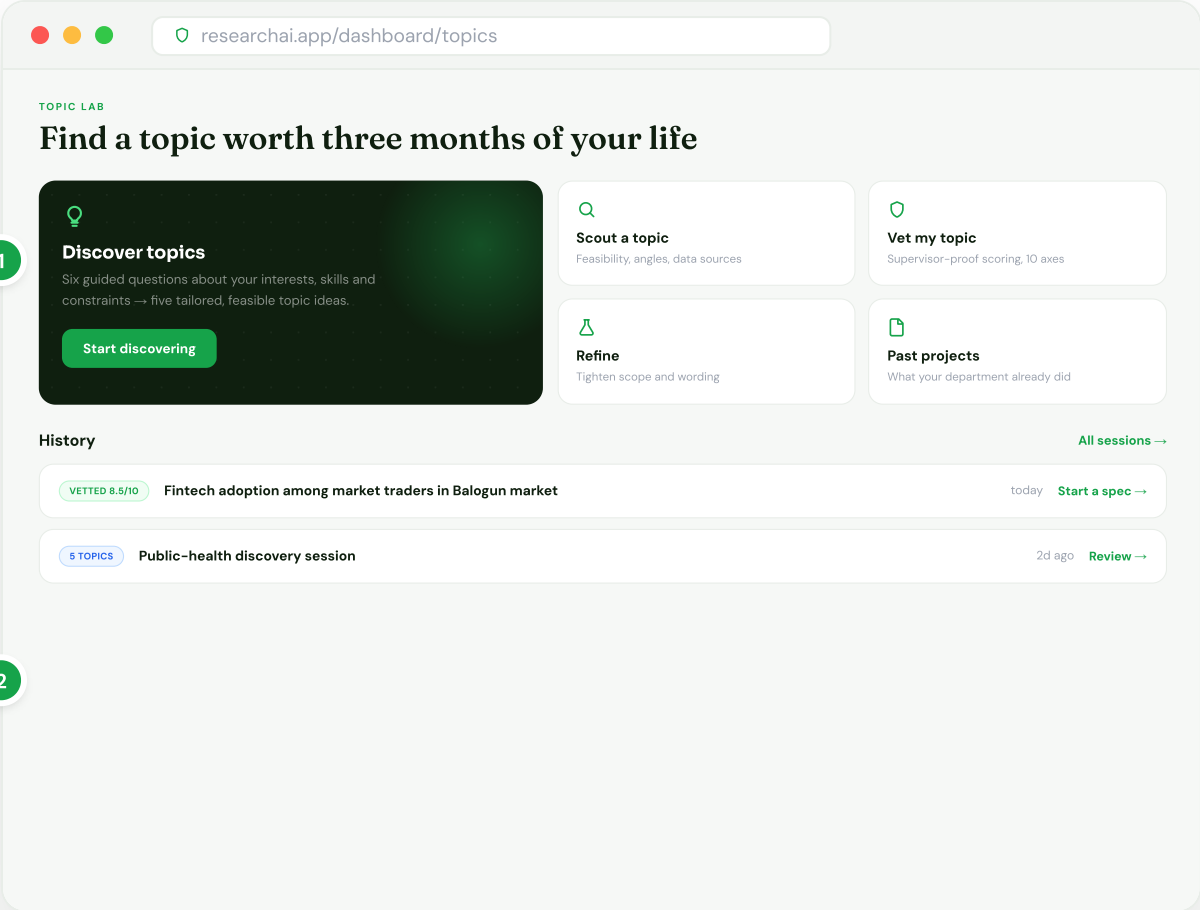
Literature15/20

- 1 Sticky table of contents — the seven real sections, active state in green tint. Reading a 4,000-word spec stops being one endless scroll.
- 2 Examiner's marks live beside the text they judge, as labeled single-hue bars — always visible while reading, never a separate tab.
- 3 The document is typeset like a document: paper surface, Georgia at 1.85 line-height, numbered serif section heads. UI chrome (badges, ring, buttons) stays outside the paper edge.
- 4 Reviewer feedback as marginalia — green-edged notes quoting the examiner agent per section, turning the review loop's output into something a student actually reads. "Regenerate weak sections" exposes the targeted-regeneration feature the backend already has.

THE EMOTIONAL BEAT

This is the screen where the product pays off. It should feel like being handed a marked manuscript by a careful supervisor — not like reading a JSON response.

Topic Lab & rollout



- 1 A hub, not a mega-page:** Discover as the dark hero card, four tools as equal cards — each tool becomes its own route, retiring the current 1,160-line single page.
- 2 History rows chain into the pipeline** — a vetted topic's next step ("Start a spec →") is right on the row, connecting Topic Lab to Generate the way the backend already links them.

ROLLOUT — 4 PHASES, EACH SHIPPABLE

- 1 Tokens + primitives** — globals.css variables, ~12 components in components/ui/ (replacing the dead ones) ~3 DAYS
- 2 Auth family + landing** — one template kills the blue/purple outliers; landing adopts the hero ~4 DAYS
- 3 Dashboard + wizard + reader** — inline styles out, primitives in; mobile patterns from doc 01 land here too ~1.5 WKS
- 4 Topic Lab split** — per-tool routes + lib/api.ts + React Query migration, last and largest ~1 WK

DEFINITION OF DONE

One CSS file of tokens · zero inline style={{}} on rebuilt pages · zero hand-rolled icons · every visual decision traceable to sheet 3 or 4. The four design systems become one, and stay one.